

Parag Kulkarni

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- Over 6+ years of experience as a Business Analyst, driving strategic initiatives, optimizing operations, and delivering actionable insights to propel business growth.
- Expert in eliciting and analyzing functional and data requirements, ensuring a comprehensive understanding of organizational needs and fostering effective decision-making.
- Versatile in employing diverse development and testing methodologies, including Waterfall, Rapid Application Development (RAD), and Agile, seamlessly adapting to varied project environments.
- Adept at documenting business processes, developing technical specifications, and facilitating user testing to ensure high-quality deliverables.
- Proven track record in defining and implementing business process improvements, troubleshooting complex issues, and collaborating with stakeholders to translate requirements into effective solutions.
- Skilled in conducting meetings, reviews, and customer interviews to foster collaboration and maintain clear communication across cross-functional teams.
- Experienced in facilitating Agile methodologies and Scrum ceremonies, driving team collaboration and continuous improvement to deliver high-quality projects.
- Proven track record in managing comprehensive project plans and timelines, ensuring successful delivery of projects on time and within budget while engaging stakeholders effectively.
- Proficient in preparing comprehensive Business Requirements Documents (BRDs) that facilitate seamless transitions from requirements gathering to implementation.
- Effective liaison between management and development teams, ensuring alignment of project requirements and adherence to quality assurance objectives.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Business Analysis:** Requirements Gathering, Process Documentation, Use Case Development, Functional Specifications
- **ETL Tools:** SQL Server Analysis Services (SSAS), SQL Server Integration Services (SSIS)
- **Reporting Tools:** SQL Server Reporting Services (SSRS), Power BI, Tableau, MS SharePoint
- **Data Visualization:** Data Storytelling, Dashboard Creation, Visual Analytics
- **Advanced Analytics:** Predictive Modeling, Statistical Analysis, Data Mining Techniques
- **Data Warehousing:** Data Warehouse Design, ETL Process Design, Data Lakes
- **Big Data Technologies:** Apache Hadoop, Apache Spark, NoSQL Databases (e.g., MongoDB, Cassandra)
- **Cloud Technologies:** AWS (Amazon Redshift, QuickSight), Microsoft Azure (Azure SQL, Azure Data Factory), GCP (BigQuery)
- **Scripting Languages:** Python (Pandas, NumPy)
- **Machine Learning:** Basic ML Algorithms (Regression, Classification), Model Evaluation Techniques, Familiarity with ML Libraries (e.g., Scikit-learn, TensorFlow)
- **Project Management:** Scope Management, Risk Analysis, Cost-Benefit Analysis, Change Management
- **Methodologies:** Agile, Waterfall, Lean Principles, Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC), Test-Driven Development (TDD)
- **Tools & Technologies:** Microsoft Office 365, Advanced Excel, MS Project, ServiceNow, Jira
- **Collaboration Tools:** Confluence, Slack, Microsoft Teams
- **Quality Assurance:** Data Quality Assessment, Data Cleansing Techniques
- **Programming Languages:** T-SQL, SQL, PL/SQL
- **Databases:** MS SQL Server (2008/2012/2014/2016)
- **Operating Systems:** Windows, Unix, Mac OS
- **Office Tools:** MS Word, MS Excel, MS PowerPoint, MS Project, MS Outlook
- **Design Tools:** MS Visio, MS Excel, HTML, CSS
- **Soft Skills:** Critical Thinking, Detail-Oriented, Strong Communication Skills, Presentation Skills

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Goldman Sachs Global Business Analyst

May 2020 - Current

- Documented comprehensive business and system requirements, effectively translating them into detailed technical specifications and acceptance criteria to guide development.
- Applied systems engineering methodologies to conduct thorough cost, benefit, and risk analyses, managing scope and schedules throughout the product lifecycle, leading to a 25% improvement in on-time project delivery.
- Utilized project management tools such as JIRA and Confluence to track project progress, manage backlogs, and facilitate transparent communication among team members, reducing project bottlenecks by 20%.

- Oversaw the integration of new technologies and tools to enhance project delivery, including cloud-based solutions and automation tools, resulting in a 35% increase in productivity and reduced manual processes.
- Developed client-facing materials to support sales and service efforts, improving communication during client conversations and renewal discussions, contributing to a 40% improvement in client retention rates.
- Facilitated requirements walkthrough sessions, documenting business constraints and assumptions to align stakeholder expectations and project objectives, achieving a 15% reduction in requirement changes during the project lifecycle.
- Created detailed training documentation and conducted engaging training sessions for end-users, promoting smooth adoption and utilization of new systems.
- Established and maintained user testing strategies, including plans and scripts, actively participating in test execution to ensure product quality and functionality.
- Identified and documented project issues and risks, providing actionable recommendations and solutions to stakeholders for effective impact mitigation.
- Troubleshoot business issues related to supporting technologies, collaborating with IT teams to resolve problems and enhance system performance.
- Managed several projects (small to enterprise level) and directed cross-functional teams to support project objectives.
- Managed the transition of projects to operations mode and oversaw the closeout process for all projects.

Verizon Wireless Systems Business Analyst

Jun 2017 - Apr 2020

- Led test case management, automation, and defect tracking, optimizing workflows in alignment with Agile Scrum methodologies to enhance testing efficiency by 30%.
- Created and maintained comprehensive test plans and test scripts, executing thorough cross-platform testing for both iOS and Android applications.
- Streamlined User Acceptance Testing (UAT) processes, collaborating with development teams to resolve defects swiftly, improving system performance by 20%.
- Documented business processes and data requirements, reviewed design documentation, and provided actionable recommendations for business process improvements.
- Contributed to the development of project delivery timelines, effectively managing projects and resources to ensure successful completion.
- Updated requirements based on user feedback and changes in application functionality to maintain alignment with business needs.
- Coordinated with IT and development teams to align technical requirements, security protocols, and compliance standards, ensuring streamlined project execution and minimizing risks.
- Implemented metrics and KPIs to measure team performance and project outcomes, using data-driven insights to identify areas for improvement and optimize workflows.
- Analyzed test results and implemented corrective actions, significantly improving software quality and reducing post-release issues by 30%.
- Actively participated in daily stand-up meetings, sprint planning sessions, and retrospectives to ensure alignment with project goals and timelines.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to gather requirements and provide actionable feedback, increasing test coverage and overall project efficiency by 20%.

EDUCATION

- **Masters of Science**
Kentucky State University (Frankfort, KY)
- **Bachelor in Fisheries science**
Konkan Agricultural University